

/Games and Toys I liked?/

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My favorite toy then: LEGO

History

- LEGO is one of the most successful toy brands in history
- A toymaker was about to go out of business, but then invented it

Why I liked it

- Tell own stories with the characters, like fanfic
- Friendship
- Consumerism



My favorite game then: Club Penguin

History

- Developed independently in 2005, bought by Disney in 2007,

Why I liked it

- Escapism
- Meeting up with friends
- Lots of surface-level exciting things to do
- Events with copyrighted and trademarked material
- Consumerism



Consumerism

- Emerged in the 1890's, ramped up in the post-WWII era
- “Normal” way to exist is to buy copious amounts of luxury goods
- A good way to inoculate the population against communism
- I liked these as a kid because I thought that was how you be an adult

My favorite toy now: Bear

History

- Got him when I was one year old from my aunt.
- Bears became a popular toy after Teddy Roosevelt refused to shoot a bear while hunting

Why I like him

- He's a stuffed animal
- You can hug him
- Familiarity



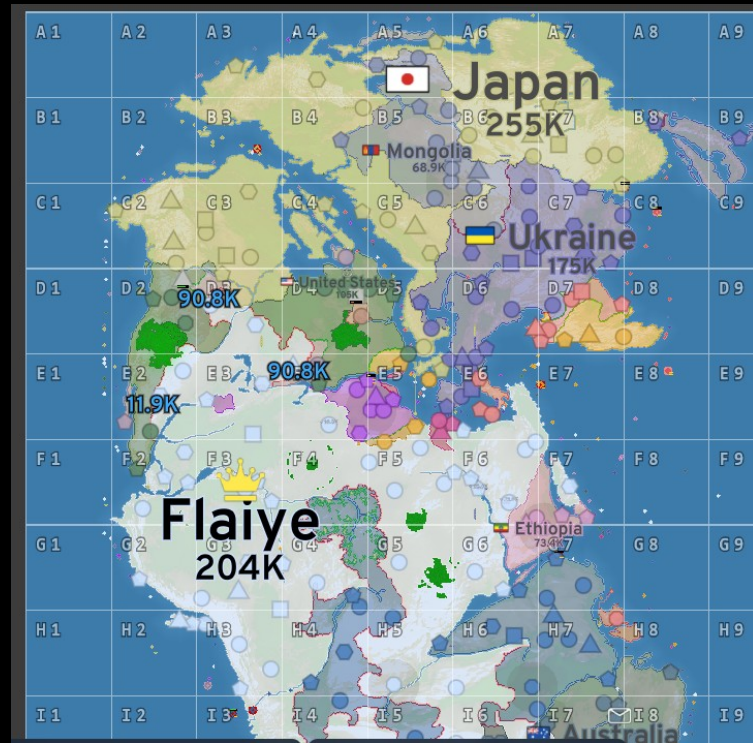
My favorite game now: Openfront.io

History

- Developed from 2024- primarily by Evan Pelle

Why I like it

- Calming
- Repetitive
- Satisfying to watch
- Vaguely related to my interest in geopolitics
- Can listen to video essays or podcasts while playing it
- Free → anti-consumerist



References

- The LEGO story
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=NdDU_BBjW9Y
- The Walt Disney Company Acquires Club Penguin
<https://thewaltdisneycompany.com/press-releases/the-walt-disney-company-acquires-club-penguin/>
- Teddy bear https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Teddy_bear
- Openfront.io git log
<https://github.com/openfrontio/OpenFrontIO.git>